

# NAPCS Unionization Research — State — Charter School Overview

## Indiana — IEERB/NLRB R25 Jurisdiction — June 6, 2026 [RESEARCH DEFERRED]

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### Section 1: State Overview

|                            |                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                       |
|----------------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| State                      | Indiana                                                                                                                                                                                                                                               |
| Labor Board                | IEERB/NLRB R25 — Indiana Education Employment Relations Board / National Labor Relations Board, Region 25 (Indianapolis)                                                                                                                              |
| Governing Law              | Ind. Code §20-24 (Charter Schools). Ind. Code §20-24-6 — charter teachers are at-will employees of the charter school. IEERB has jurisdiction over public employers; independently operated charters may fall under NLRB R25. Jurisdiction unsettled. |
| Federal NLRB Jurisdiction  | YES — Jurisdiction split — some IN charters may be public employers under IEERB; independently operated charters likely NLRB R25. Jurisdictional analysis required per school.                                                                        |
| Right-to-Work              | Right-to-Work State — Ind. Code §22-6-6                                                                                                                                                                                                               |
| For-Profit Operator Status | For-profit EMO management contracts permitted under state law                                                                                                                                                                                         |
| Card-Check Available       | NO — RTW state; no card-check statute.                                                                                                                                                                                                                |
| Research Status            | DEFERRED — Executive Sponsor direction, June 7, 2026 (PDR-018). Charter schools assumed unorganized. No school-level research conducted.                                                                                                              |

### Section 2: Charter School Landscape

Research deferred — Executive Sponsor direction (PDR-018, June 7, 2026). Charter schools assumed unorganized. Charter universe and enrollment figures are sourced from Charter School Registry v133 and NCES ELSI 2024–25. No school-level research has been conducted.

| Category                          | Schools | % of Total | Notes                                                                                                         |
|-----------------------------------|---------|------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| No Organizing Activity Documented | 132     | 100%       | Research deferred — Executive Sponsor direction (PDR-018, June 7, 2026). Charter schools assumed unorganized. |
| Total Charter Schools in Indiana  | 132     | 100%       | Source: Charter School Registry v133 (NCES ELSI 2024–25).                                                     |

### Charter School Enrollment

|                                                |                                                                                                                                                                                        |
|------------------------------------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Total Charter Enrollment                       | 54,937 students — 5.3% of state K–12 enrollment (1,040,190 total K–12 students)                                                                                                        |
| Students in CMO/EMO-Affiliated Charter Schools | N/A — research deferred; charter schools assumed unorganized                                                                                                                           |
| Students in Organized Charter Schools          | N/A — research deferred; charter schools assumed unorganized                                                                                                                           |
| Data Sources                                   | Charter enrollment: NCES ELSI 2024–25 / Charter School Registry v133. Total K–12 state enrollment: NCES ELSI 2024–25 (all public schools). Both figures from the same source and year. |

## Section 3: Charter Management Organizations & Education Management Organizations

Charter Management Organizations (CMOs) are nonprofit networks. Education Management Organizations (EMOs) are for-profit management companies. Data sourced from Charter School Registry v133. Union penetration reflects confirmed organized schools as of the data currency date.

| CMO / EMO Name                         | Type     | State Campuses | National Campuses <sup>†</sup> | Organized in State | Total Enrollment |
|----------------------------------------|----------|----------------|--------------------------------|--------------------|------------------|
| Goodwill Excel Centers                 | Network‡ | 24             | —                              | —                  | 6,229            |
| Phalen Leadership Academies Indiana    | Network‡ | 6              | —                              | —                  | 1,951            |
| KIPP Indianapolis                      | Network‡ | 3              | —                              | —                  | 1,442            |
| Options Charter Schools                | Network‡ | 3              | —                              | —                  | 1,043            |
| Purdue Polytechnic High Schools        | Network‡ | 3              | —                              | —                  | 967              |
| Avondale Meadows                       | Network‡ | 2              | —                              | —                  | 524              |
| Christel House Academies               | Network‡ | 2              | —                              | —                  | 971              |
| Circle City Prep Charter School        | Network‡ | 2              | —                              | —                  | 418              |
| TOTAL — All CMO/EMO Schools in Indiana |          | 45             |                                | —                  | 13,545           |
| of which organized                     |          |                |                                | —                  | —                |

Total enrollment shown is the combined enrollment of all CMO/EMO network schools in Indiana. Organized network schools: 0 organized schools in network-affiliated charters.

<sup>†</sup> National Campuses reflects total campuses operated by this network across all states, as reported in Charter School Registry v133. Provides context for networks operating in multiple states.

<sup>‡</sup> Network (type unclassified) = operator present in Charter School Registry v133 but not yet classified in CMO Reference data. Contact registry project to add classification for these records.

8 network (type unclassified). Approximately 87 schools operate independently with no CMO/EMO affiliation. Source: Charter School Registry v133.

## Section 4: Legal Framework & Charter School Overview

Findings are based on research as of June 6, 2026.

### 1: Legal & Jurisdictional Framework

Ind. Code §20-24 (Charter Schools). Ind. Code §20-24-6 — charter teachers are at-will employees of the charter school. IEERB has jurisdiction over public employers; independently operated charters may fall under NLRB R25. Jurisdiction unsettled. Indiana is a right-to-work state (Ind. Code §22-6-6). Charter schools in Indiana are subject to NLRB jurisdiction as private employers (IEERB/NLRB R25). Secret ballot NLRB election is the required organizing pathway. Card-check is not available.

### 2: Charter School Structure

Indiana operates 132 open-enrollment charter schools, enrolling approximately 54,937 students. 8 charter management organizations and education management organizations operate in Indiana. The largest networks by campus count are Goodwill Excel Centers (24 campuses in state), Phalen Leadership Academies Indiana (6 campuses in state), KIPP Indianapolis (3 campuses in state). Approximately 87 schools operate independently

with no CMO or EMO affiliation. Network-level detail, including campus counts and total enrollment, appears in Section 3 above. No school-level union research has been conducted. Research deferred — Executive Sponsor direction (PDR-018, June 7, 2026).

## Section 5: Media Coverage & Public Stakeholder Positions

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### Press Coverage

No press coverage of charter school employee organizing has been identified in Indiana. charter school community coverage focuses on school accountability, urban enrollment patterns in Indianapolis, and CMO performance.

### Legislative Context

No charter school community collective bargaining legislation has been introduced in the Indiana General Assembly. Indiana enacted right-to-work legislation in 2012 (Ind. Code §22-6-6). Charter law amendments have addressed governance and accountability; labor relations are not addressed in Ind. Code §20-24.

## Section 6: Contract & CBA Access Registry

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*No collective bargaining agreements documented for this state. Research deferred — charter schools assumed unorganized (PDR-018, June 7, 2026).*